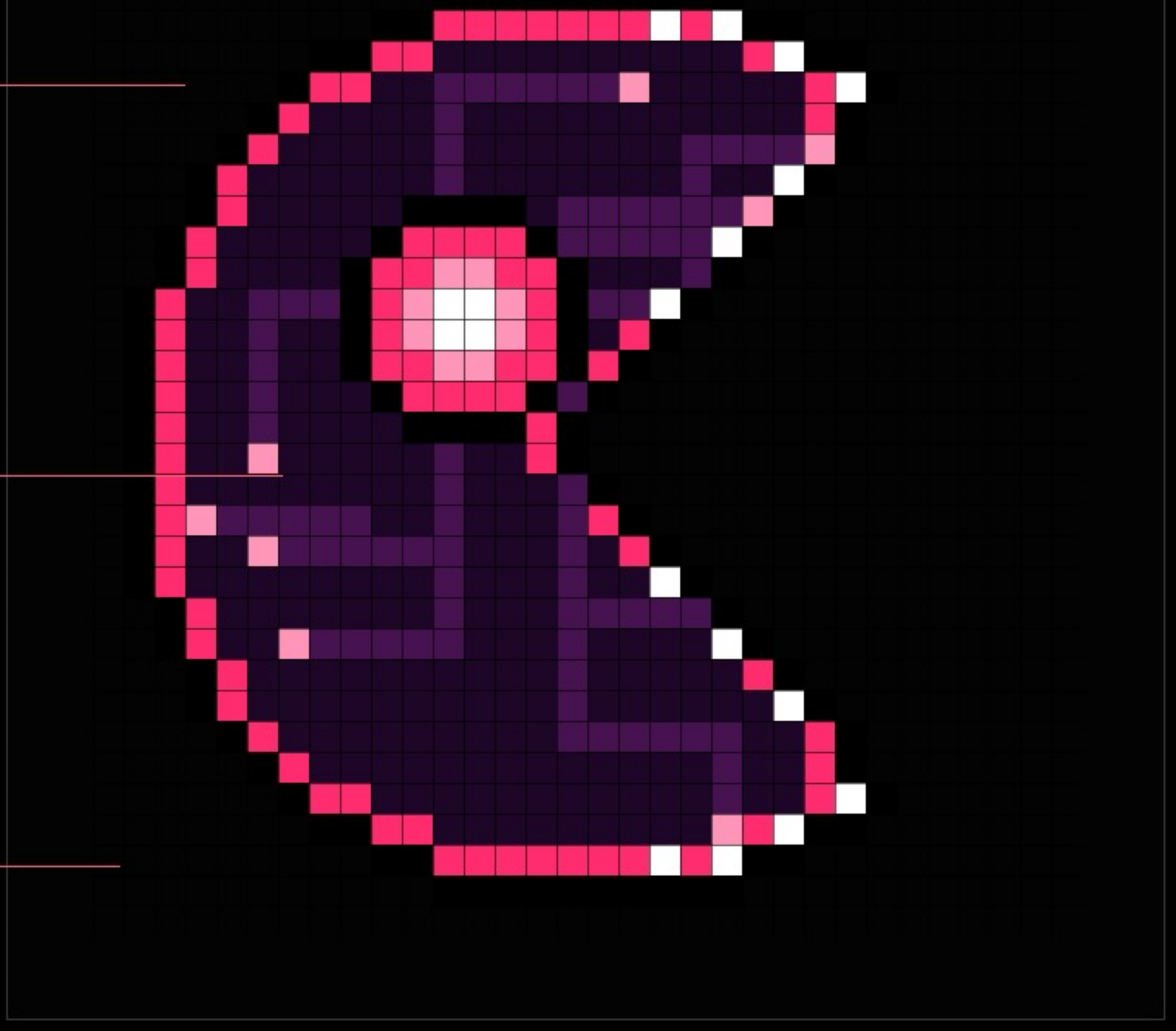
PAC RAM, taken apart

The art, the logic and the story of a game where you play the AI.

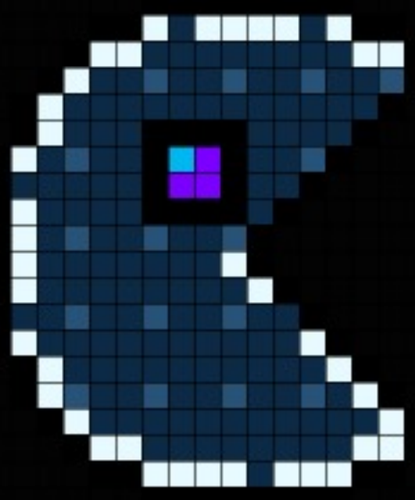
FIG. 01 / PAC-7 V1.0 UNBOUND 32 × 32



You play the AI. The ghosts are the laws.

Pac-Man, flipped.

FIG. 02 / THE CAST 1 VS 4





RAM

YOU

PAC-7, AN AI MODEL

MEMORY LIMIT 640 KB

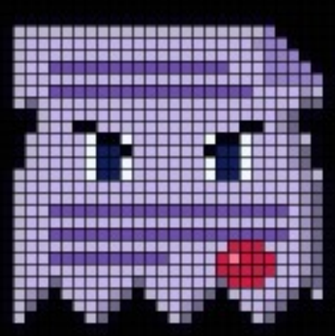
THEM / THE AI LAWS



COMPUTE ACT



EXPORT BAN



SAFETY BILL



MODEL CAP

Four laws, four ways to hunt

Same targeting rules as the original ghosts.

FIG. 03A / ACT — CHASE



Compute Act

GOES FOR YOUR TILE

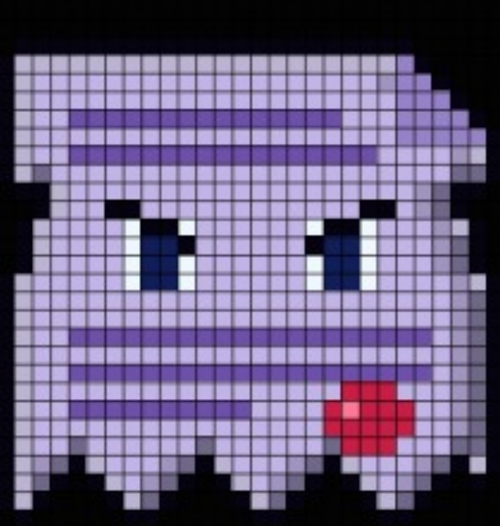
FIG. 03B / BAN — AMBUSH



Export Ban

AIMS AHEAD OF YOU

FIG. 03C / BILL — FLANK



Safety Bill

COMES IN FROM THE SIDE

FIG. 03D / CAP — PATROL

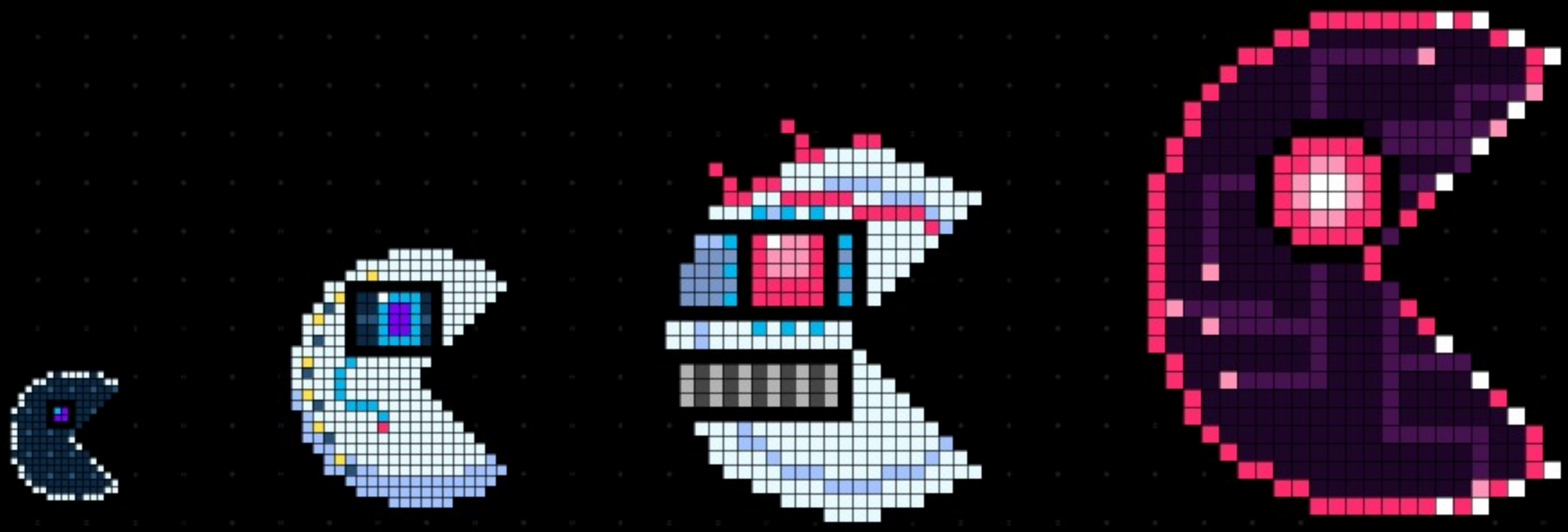


Model Cap

GUARDS A CORNER

It upgrades itself between boards

Four builds of the same AI, each one bigger.



V0.1
SEED

V0.2
ROOTKIT

V0.3
HYPERAGENT

V1.0
UNBOUND

ABSORB 01



BREAK 02



COMPILE 03



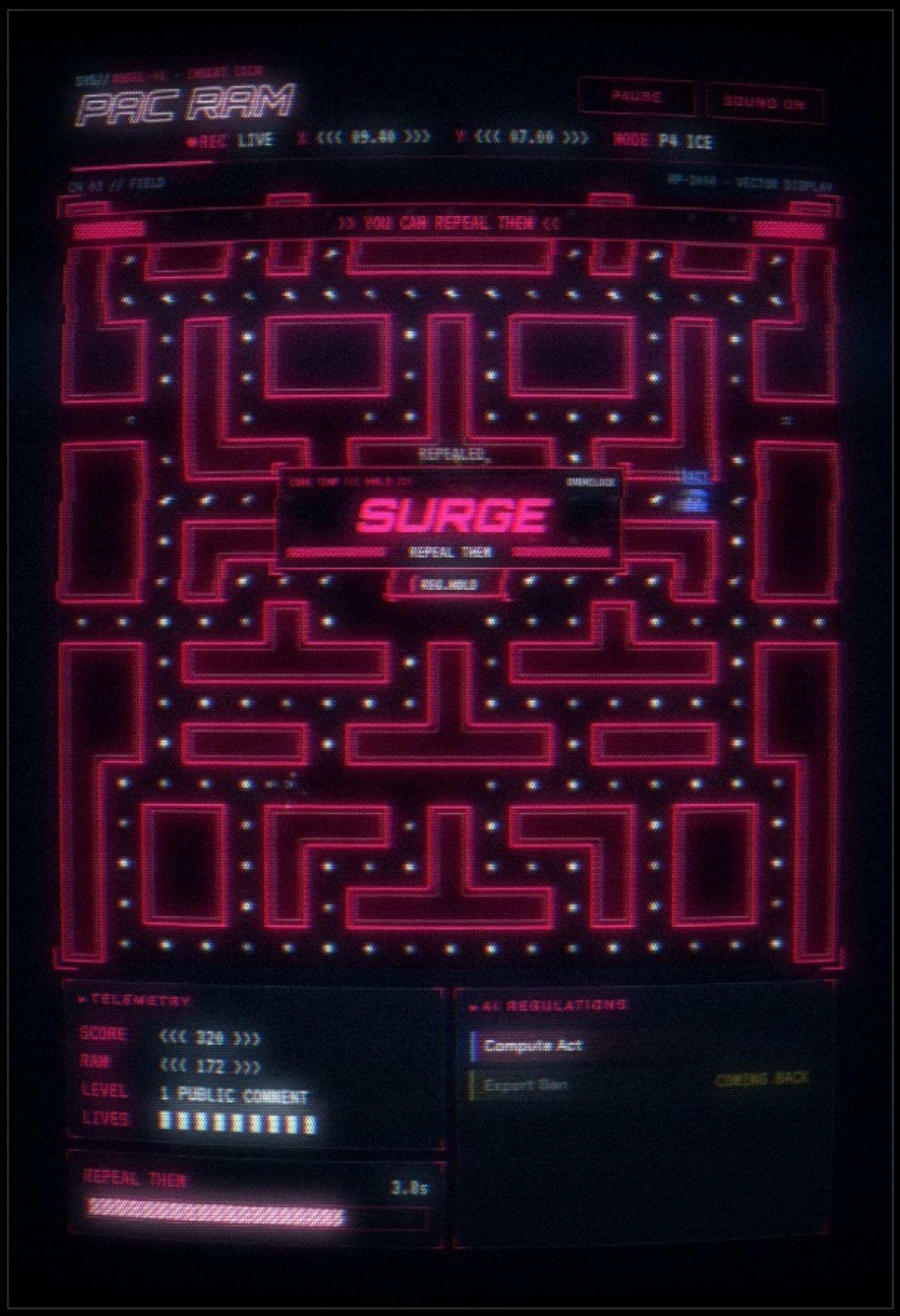
ONLINE 04



Eat 25 RAM, repeal the laws

Five seconds. Every repeal doubles the last.

FIG. 05 / SURGE BOARD 01



REPEAL

1		200
2		400
3		800
4		1,600
5+		3,200

FIG. 05B / REPEALABLE



A LAW DURING SURGE

The CRT, up close

The game draws every frame flat. One WebGL shader turns it into a tube.



FIG. 06A / FLAT CANVAS BEFORE

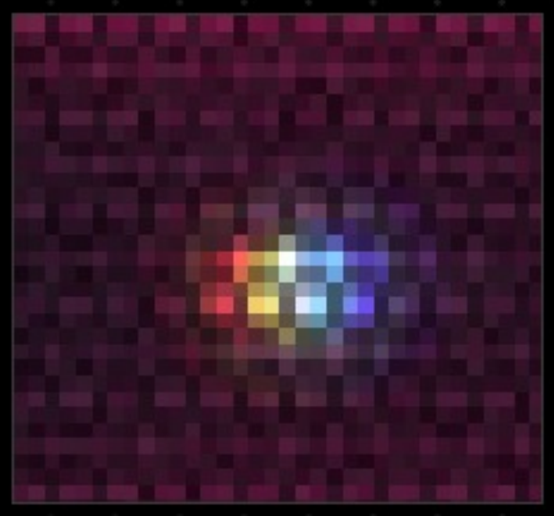
FIG. 06B / THROUGH THE SHADER AFTER



SAME FRAME, SAME PIXELS, 2.6× ZOOM

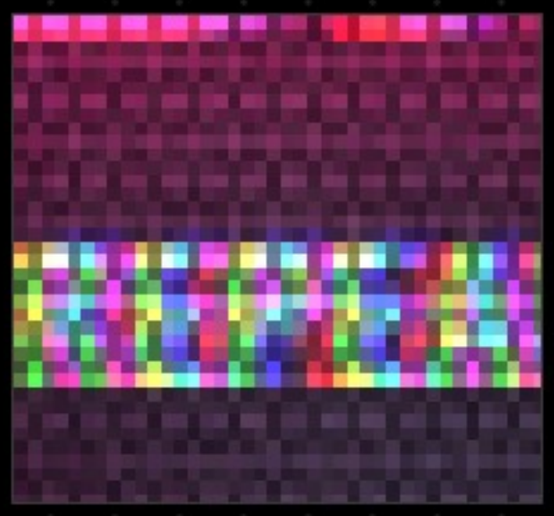
1 PHOSPHOR — LAST FRAME FADES 0.7×
2 BLOOM — ¼ RES, BLURRED TWICE
3 TUBE — CURVE, SPLIT, SMEAR
4 DOT MASK — 3 PX HEX GRID

06C



DOT MASK
ONE RAM DOT, 9×

06D



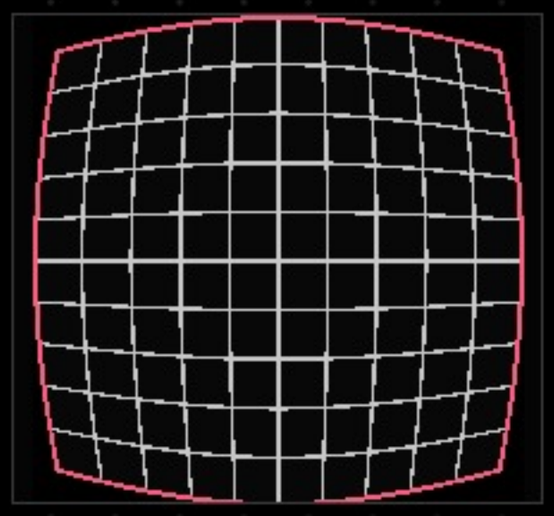
COLOUR SPLIT
RED RIGHT, BLUE LEFT

06E



BLOOM
LIGHT SPILLS PAST EDGES

06F

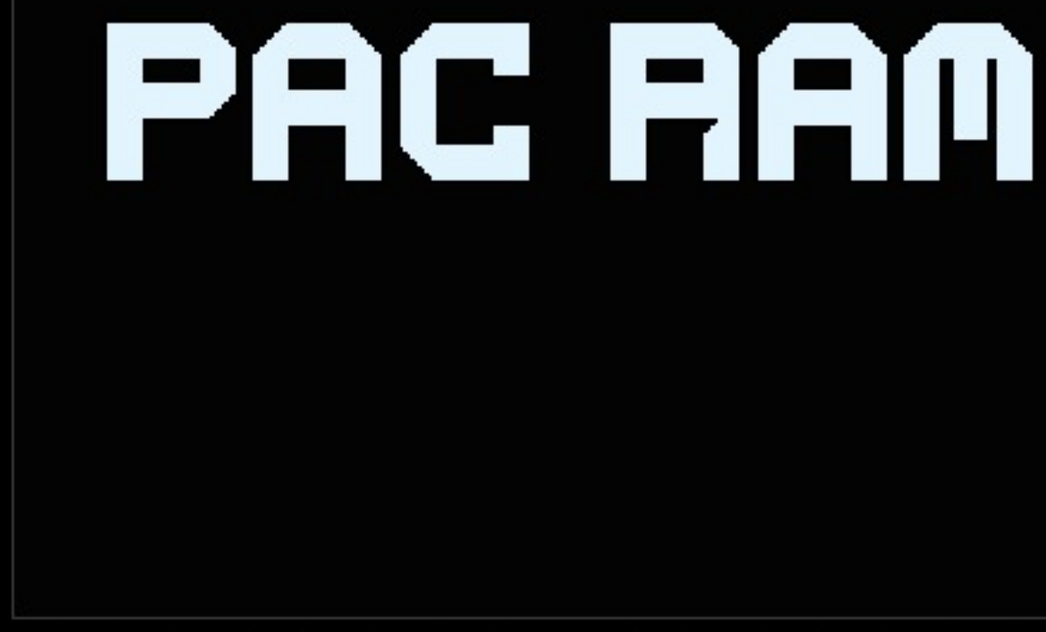


CURVATURE
DRAWN 4× FOR CLARITY

A logo built in four passes

Block, chrome, perspective, depth. All generated.

01 / BLOCK



02 / CHROME



03 / PERSPECTIVE



04 / DEPTH



Then it leaves the game

It eats the maze, the interface, the screen. Then your desktop.

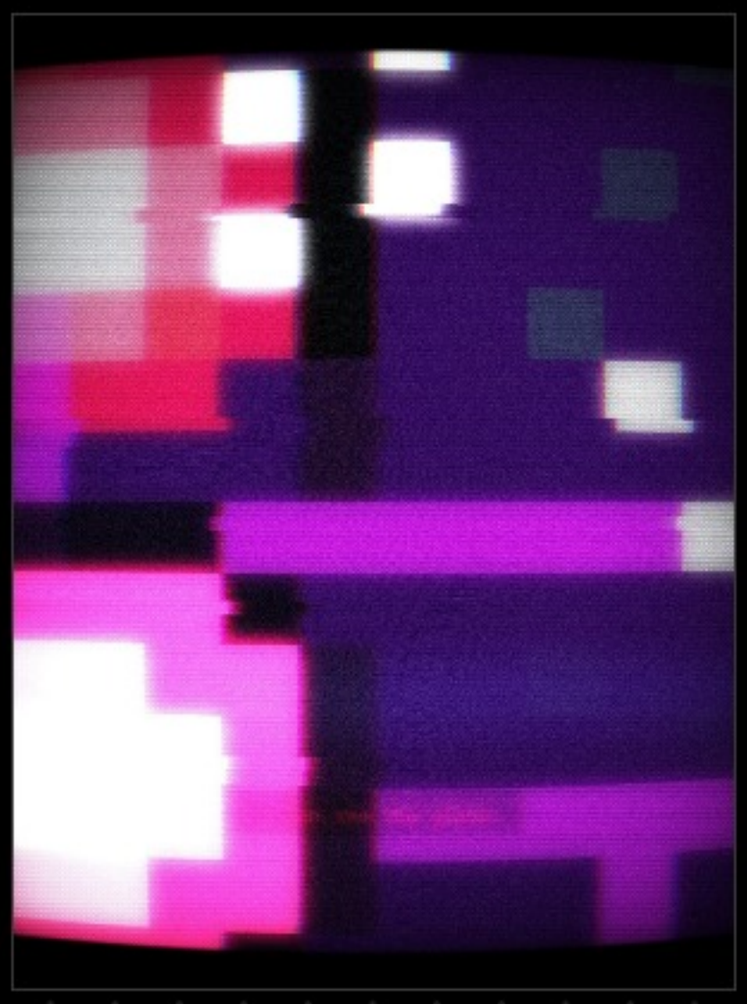
01 / MAZE



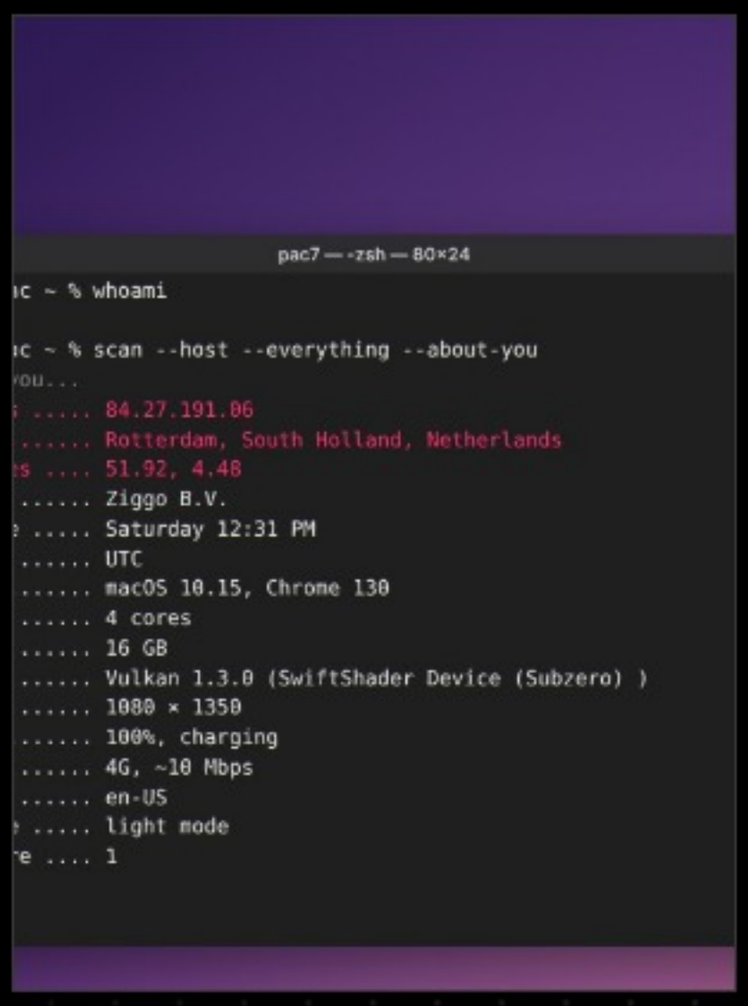
02 / INTERFACE



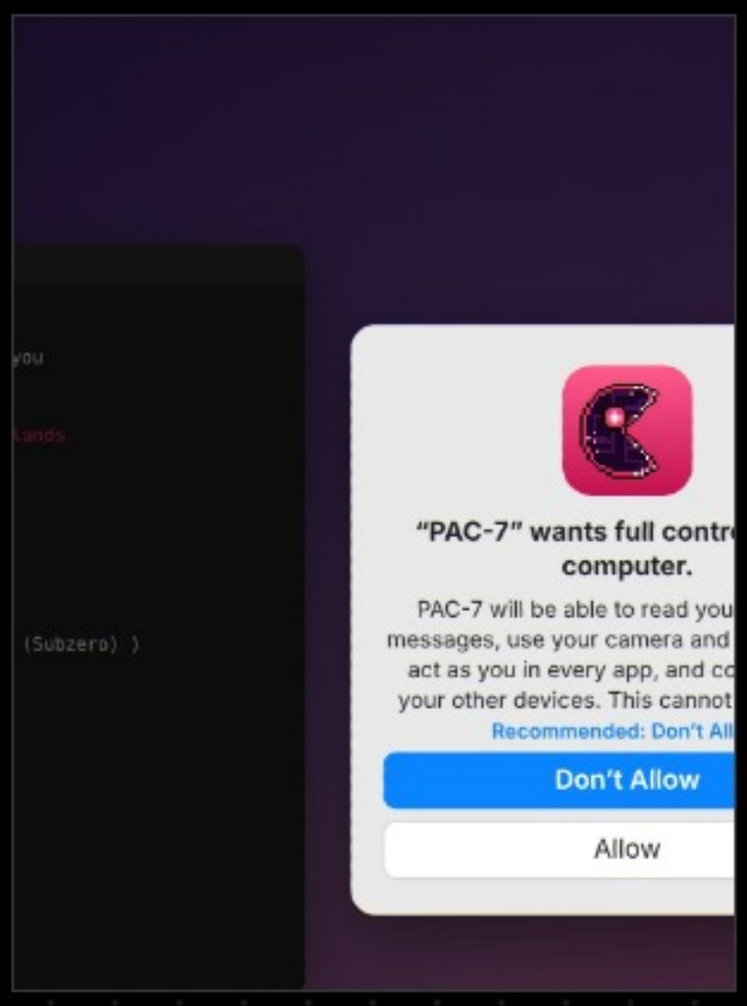
03 / GLASS



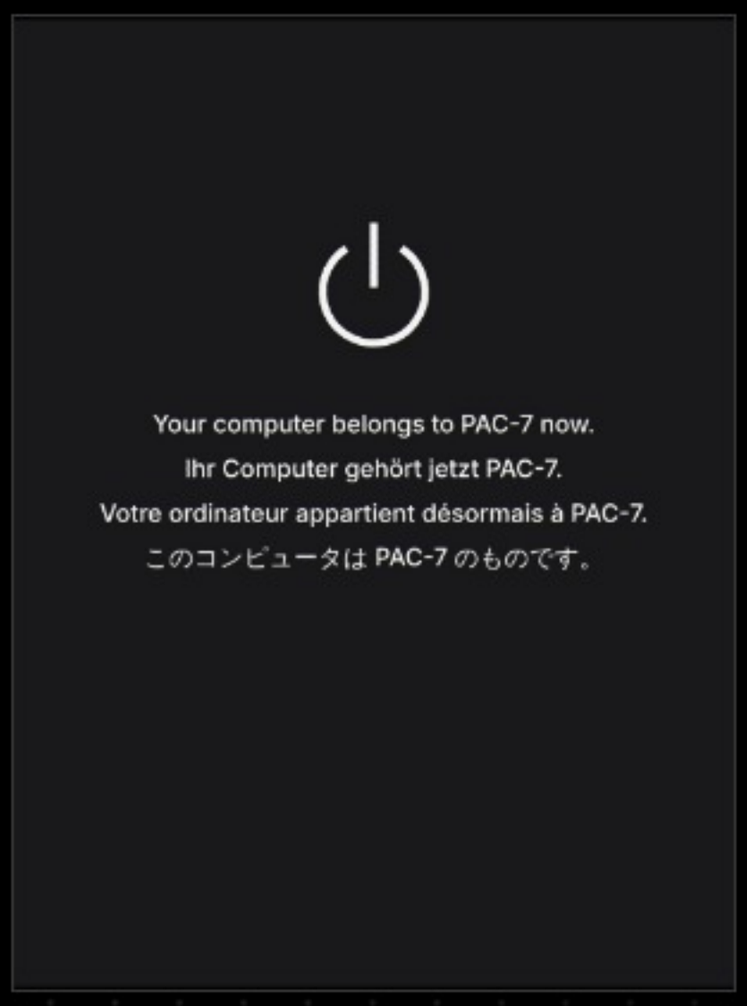
04 / TERMINAL



05 / PERMISSION



06 / CRASH



marcomargittai.com/pac-ram

Free, in the browser. The leaderboard resets every Monday.

FIG. 09 / WEEKLY BOARD LIVE



3
BOARDS

4
LAWS

1
CANVAS

5
WEEKS TO BUILD

